



**Swashbuckling:** Vaibhav Suryavanshi has made power-hitting look like child's play since his first taste of IPL last year, during which he cracked a 35-ball century.

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# India's dominance masks a transition problem

Vaibhav Suryavanshi and a select group of young stars aim to extend India's Under-19 World Cup stranglehold. But will their success solve the **big picture?**

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**T**raditional powerhouse and five-time champion India is always a firm favourite at the U-19 World Cup, underscoring the success of the country's robust youth cricket system. India's overflowing trophy cabinet is not merely attributable to the luxury of tapping

into a large talent pool but is also the result of well-planned scheduling that prioritises game time against challenging opponents. India has played 21 Youth ODIs since the 2024 World Cup final defeat to the Aussies, 11 of which have been on overseas tours of England, Australia and South Africa.

The investment has reaped rich dividends, with stars such as Rishabh Pant, Shubman Gill and Yashasvi Jaiswal emerging from the